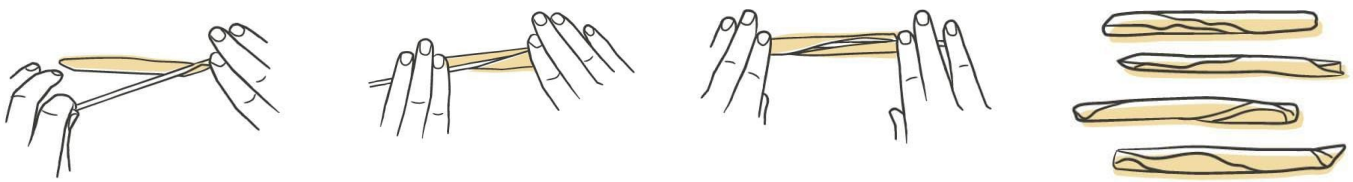
FILEJA

REGION	REST
Calabria, near Tropea	**1 to 2 hours**

METHOD

1. Make semolina dough. Dust a wooden board with a little 00 flour. Line a sheet pan with parchment, then dust the parchment with semolina.
2. Quarter the dough. Work one piece and keep the rest under plastic wrap or a towel.
3. Press the piece into a thick rope by hand. Set the fingertips of both hands together at its midpoint, then roll back and forth while walking your hands apart toward the ends.
4. Keep rolling under light pressure until the rope is about 1/2 inch across, roughly as thick as a Sharpie. Cut it in half and roll the halves separately if it gets too long to handle.
5. Cut the rope into 1-inch lengths with a knife or bench scraper. Cover the pieces you are not shaping.
6. Take one 1-inch piece and roll it out the same way into a thinner rope, pencil-thick and about 5 inches long.
7. Lay the rope parallel to the edge of the board. Press the iron into its right end with the iron's left end angled underneath, spread four fingers of each hand along the iron, and roll it up and away from you, flattening the rope lightly as it winds into a wide coil.
8. Turn the coil back parallel to you and roll it gently on the board to even out the thickness. Push too hard and the pasta grips the iron, then unwinds as you pull it off.
9. Ease the shape off the iron onto the sheet pan. Work through the rest of the cut pieces.
10. Repeat from step 3 with the remaining dough.
11. Dry 1 to 2 hours, until the pasta stiffens slightly and holds its shape when handled.
12. To hold it, wrap the pan in plastic and refrigerate up to 24 hours.

SHAPING



1 2 3 4

NOTES

Dimensions run 1/2-inch rope, cut at 1 inch, then each piece re-rolled pencil-thin and 5 inches long before shaping.
Needs a ferretto, or maccheroni iron: a thin rod about the gauge of a knitting needle, which will substitute. It comes round or square, and square is preferred.
The coil is wide and open, which is what separates fileja from the tight spiral of busiate.
Refrigerator limit is 24 hours.
Classically sauced with tomato and 'nduja, Calabria's soft spicy sausage. The shape is chewy and holds up to heavy sauces.

DOUGH
Semolina Dough

Makes: 750 g / Active Time: 8-10 min kneading / Rest: 30 min minimum, wrapped

INGREDIENTS

325 g	Tipo 00 flour
175 g	Semolina flour
250 g	Lukewarm water
up to 1 tbsp, only if dry	Room-temperature water

METHOD

1. Stir the two flours together thoroughly, then mound on a wooden surface with a well 5 to 6 inches across.
2. Add the water slowly. Water has no body of its own, so it escapes far more easily than yolks do.
3. Draw in flour from the inner wall with a fork as you pour, working round the circumference until all the water is in.
4. Knead 8 to 10 minutes, pressing down and away, rotating, folding.
5. Add water by the tablespoon only if it stays dry.
6. Wrap and rest at least 30 minutes.

NOTES

> Eggless, so it stays more elastic and less tender than egg dough. Do not expect the Play-Doh feel here.
> 50% hydration against 500 g total flour.
> 65% of the flour is 00 and 35% semolina.
> Keeps 24 hours. Chilled overnight, pull it out 20 minutes before rolling.

DATE ___ / ___ / ___ RATING ___ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____

_____